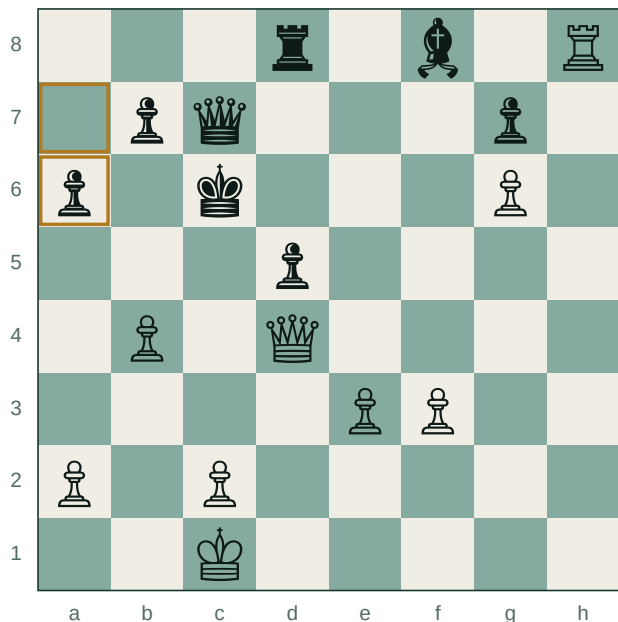


Forks and double attacks: White, move 27

Forks and double attacks

White to move



Previous move: 26...a6. Gold borders mark its start and finish.

WORKED CONTINUATION - COVER THIS SECTION FIRST

27. Rxf8 Rxf8 28. Qc5+ Kd7 29. Qxf8

27.Rxf8 The rook captures the bishop on f8. Recorded reply: **27...Rxf8**.

28.Qc5+ Check restricts Black to 1 legal reply here. From c5 it attacks king on c6 and rook on f8. Recorded reply: **28...Kd7**.

29.Qxf8 The queen captures the rook on f8.

At the end, nominal material is White 15 / Black 13 (P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9). Over this line, White's balance changes by +3. Activity and king safety still affect the evaluation.

CHECKPOINT

Using P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9, how much does White's material balance change over the complete line? **Answer:** +3: the balance goes from -1 to +2. Count promotions and every recapture, not just the first gain.

CARRY THE IDEA INTO YOUR GAMES

Two attacked pieces do not guarantee a gain if the forking piece can be captured or one target moves with check.

WHAT THIS POSITION TEACHES

A fork attacks multiple targets at once. The combination works when the defender cannot save everything or generate a stronger forcing reply.

HOW TO LOOK

Look for checking forks first, then double attacks on queens, rooks, and undefended pieces. Follow the line until the material is actually collected.

The defending king is on c6. Look for a defender that can be displaced or overloaded.